Every Time we almost Met

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47596462.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Perfuma (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Soulmates, Human Catra (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Disaster Catra (She-Ra), Catra works too much, Catra really likes muscles, Lawyer Catra

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Every Time we almost Met

by Rinnii

Summary

She was utilising her sunglasses to their full potential to shamelessly watch the blonde woman chatting to Perfuma over the counter. The woman turned to head out the door, passing Catra where she sat by the door outside. Catra pretended to be øning out and only followed the woman with her eyes to avoid getting caught.

Which is why she noticed the other woman run her eyes over Catra and seemed to enjpy the view . Catra tilted her head to look at the blonde to see if the action would make the blonde act on that look but she jµst of fered a friendly smile and headed down the street. Shame.
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Fate works in mysterious ways. f only Catra knew that Adora was out there waiting for her, all she needed to do was take a moment for herself to finally meet her.

Notes

Welcome~

Ivve been hording this for 6 months and Ijµst need to post it. I hope you enjpy the moment when Adora and Catra first meet because there is a lot of that in this fic.

Enjpy~

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra groaned as she tried to blink away the sleep from her eyes. She rolled over to check the time on her phone and frowned at the text

Unknown Number: Hey, It's Adora.

She definitely hadn't met anyone named Adora. Hell, she hadn't even been anywhere to *possibly* meet someone named Adora.

The warm noon sun was almost blinding as she rolled over to escape the twisted blankets around her. She had forgotten to close her blinds again in her haste to collapse into sleep.

She considered responding as she pushed out of bed, preferring to wake up as late as Melog would allow at every opportunity, especially on the weekends.

She went through her normal morning routine to make coffee and breakfast, uh, lunch and feed Melog his second half of breakfast. She sat at her table and considered her options. While eating her breakfast and reading her other notifications she got another follow up text

Unknown number: I had a nice time last night, when did you want to grab coffee?

She cringed, that was a little desperate. This guy was obviously not interested if he let the girl text him. Adora was a girl's name right? Time to rip the bandage off.

Me: Hey Adora, wrong number.

Unknown number: Really? That sucks.

Me: Sorry to disappoint, I'm not your dream guy.

Unknown number: lol, it wouldn't be a guy, but now I'll never know if she was my dream girl either.

Catra looked at the message for a moment. What were the odds that the wrong number was also a lesbian woman? It seemed so unreal.

Melog jumped into the breakfast table at that moment, noticing she had finished her food and loudly demanded cuddles. Catra rested him under her chin as she pet his back with one hand so she could respond to this text, suddenly more invested.

Me: If she can't handle giving you the right number, she's obviously not worth your time.

Unknown number: Youre probably right, sorry to disturb your Saturday. Have a good one.

Catra continued to look at her phone screen until it went black and she looked at herself in the reflection. Was she really so lonely that talking to a random stranger was going to be the highlight of her day?

Catra huffed in annoyance and scooped up Melog and flopped onto the couch with him. Ignoring her phone as she put on a movie to zone out. She had some emails from W eaver to respond to but she could get to that later.

I

Catra was in the park with Perfuma on their monthly run and bitch session. Catra bitching mostly. They had just finished their lap around the park and had paused before they went again.

"So she has been riding my ass more than usual, ever since Iasked for that raise,"

"That doesnt seem fair , have you talked to her about it?"

"No, Idont think talking will help, since the last time made it worse"

"That's understandable, I'm sure something will come up to help," Perfuma said with a smile and waved at someone that was running past. Catra caught a glimpse of blonde hair and tight shorts. She followed the eye candy to watch the woman as she passed.

She had stopped a little further up the path to pet a cat standing on the fence post and Catra couldn't help but appreciate the extended view.

"Get back to it, Grey!" Perfuma yelled out and the woman chuckled. She looked over at them and Catra felt so bare under those blue eyes. The woman looked Catra up and down before looking back at Perfuma.

"Have a good run, Fuma," the woman said, her voice was angelic and playful. It made a weird shiver run down Catra's spine and her skin covered in goosebumps. The woman was gone as quickly as she appeared.

"Sorry, Catra, you were saying?"

"Uh." Catra's brain stalled, she really had no idea what she had been saying before all of that just happened. Catra was apparently so thirsty that even a friendly greeting from a hot woman, not even *directed* at her, was enough to get her flustered?

‘W eaver?..

‘Right! So she made me work all last weekend and she is giving me twice the case work as everyone else!’ Catra jumped back into her rant about her horrible boss, putting those blue eyes out of her mind.

I

Almost a week had passed and Catra had all but forgotten about the texts she had received. She was working late on Friday night when her phone vibrated and she checked, expecting to see her boss asking for even more work to be done.

Unknown number: Saw her again, she apologised for the wrong number but said she wasn’t interested. Closure [peace sign]

Catra blinked at her phone with confusion, scrolling up on the chat to realise it was Adora again. She looked at the message, trying to decide if she should respond. It didn’t really warrant one but she kinda wanted to anyway. Maybe she was a little pathetic and a touch more lonely than she cared to admit.

Me: Closure is good. You’ve got some balls to confront her.

Unknown number: Gotta commit if you want the prize. It's better to know.

Adora seemed like a driven individual. She wondered for a moment what she might look like. Driven was something Catra really, *really* liked. She was sure if Adora was hot she probably wouldn't have been rejected, but then again, everyone has their own tastes.

Me: You sound like a personal trainer.

Unknown number: Funny you should say that. I am. [two right pointing hands]

Catra laughed to herself for her good guess. Lesbian personal trainer Adora, what girl was saying no thanks to that? Maybe she was a health nut. It's not very sexy to get nagged about your food choices.

Me: What lesbian would turn down all that muscle and affirmation? She's not worth your time.

Unknown number: Thanks dude. Appreciate the pep talk.

Catra looked at the word dude for probably too long, not even pretending to work anymore. It was almost midnight and she was the

last person in the office. She should probably take this work home with her to finish tomorrow. Weaver would blow a gasket if it wasnt finished by Monday.

Catra thought long and hard about what she wanted to say, did she want this random person to know she was also a woman *and* a lesbian. t could invite unwanted attention.

She wrote and deleted her nekmessage a few times. Everything she typed made her feel like a moron. t has been a long time since shes been to town or flirted. She was too invested in her pb and it took up her whole life. She was on a fast track to become a partner.

Besides seeing her best friends every few weeks she didnt really talk toanyone really . She isolated herself.

Me: Gotta support a fellow [pride flag]

She felt awkward about the message but decided to qickly move on. Packing up her laptop and all her things and hustling to her car. She couldnt stress about the response if she couldnt look at it.

Her twenty minute drive home proved that theory wrong when the tekcame through as she was driving and she had to stop herself from checking it at every traffic light.

Once she was home she gave Melog some love and put her things on the table. She looked in her freezer to pull out a frozen meal and put it in the microwave. She finally sat down to wait for her food and looked at her phone again.

Unknown number: Iappreciate your solidarity [smiling face]Ill let you enjoy your night. [fist bump]

Catra looked at her phone, not really wanting the stranger to stop texting her but also not wanting to be weird. She felt a little stupid. Instead, deciding to text the group chat with Scorpia and Entrapta to set up a hang out. She clearly needed some human interaction.

I

"You should join me for paddle boarding," Entrapta said suddenly. They had been sitting in silence in Catra's apartment for over an hour. It was good bonding and they both could get work done. Catra looked at Entrapta like she was insane.

"Since when do you paddle board?" Catra asked, unable to believe it.

"Hordak enjoys the tranquillity" Entrapta explained

"I am NOT third wheeling your date,"

“A friend of his owns the equipment. He said you might like them,”

“I like being set up on blind dates less than third wheeling!”

“Very well. Perhaps you should find activities you enjoy which are not work related,”

Catra glared at her and shook her head, going back to work as the silence settled between them again. Getting told to go outside by Entrapta was truly a new low.

I

After seeing Entrapta on Saturday afternoon for quiet time, she called Scorpia and got an update on her exciting new gym. Scorpia had been rambling about a new gym she joined so she could go with her workout buddy more often. She then went on to explain her new diet to get shredded. Catra didn't really follow all that but she was happy Scorpia had found someone to go to the gym with. She tried many times to get Catra to join her but Catra didn't really like gyms much and preferred to run outside. Scorpia invited Catra to join her again but Catra declined.

Talking to her friends reaffirmed that she didn't do much more than work. It was going to be worth it one day though. She had more

energy than usual after some socialising on the weekend that even Weaver couldnt ruin her vibe on Monday .

Sitting at her desk, slowly eating her lunch between typing a complicated document, she heard her phone vibrate. She checked it to make sure it wasnt important and was surprised to see the unknown number again. This was getting a little ridiculous, and it was even more ridiculous that she didnt mind that much.

The tekwas an image and Catra didnt think before she clicked into it and almost choked on her lunch. The image was of the most shredded abs Catra had ever seen, and the caption Ijust ate so many fries, no regrets'

Catra bit her lip and looked around her to make sure no one could see her phone like she was going to get caught receiving dirty tekts. t was lunchtime and most of the of fice was empty. Catra looked back at the phone like it would help her think of something to say and not break her brain completely.

Things Catra knew about Adora: Lesbian, a personal trainer, driven, likes to go out on Fridays, has abs Catra would like to lick. What the hell was happening to her life? She had such a simple, no nonsense life before this random stranger decided to show up and start ticking boxes. *This was ridiculous. Who sends a text like this?!*

While Catra was staring at the flawless pale skin and the gold band of some gym shorts, she got a follow up tek

Unknown number: OMG, Im so sorry dude. That was not meant for you. Please delete, thats so embarrassing.

Catra couldnt help the smirk that came to her lips at the obviously flustered follow up. It was a little cute, but it also explained a lot. She wondered who she was texting this to, maybe a girl she was wooing? Catra bit her lip, feeling a little bold.

Me: Id like to subscribe to this newsletter .

Unknown number: Ha ha, Ican share my workout plan if you want.

Me: Absolutely not, Idont want abs like that. Ijust want to SEE them.

Catra waited for a response but it was taking a long time and she eventually went back to eating. Maybe she came on a bit strong, and maybe its been a while. Shes a little thirsty but her request was *valid* .

After a full ten minutes'wait the next text came through and Catra was probably a bit eager to read it.

Unknown number: Abs arent for everyone. Ican respect that.

Catra looked at the nonplus response, it wasnt flirty at all. Catra maybe wanted Adora to play along. This was ridiculous, she didnt know this woman and she should not be flirting with her. Maybe the abs went to her head a little.

After several attempts to write something back Catra groaned at herself and decided she needed to get laid and forget about this random stranger. She put her phone down and went back to work.

I

Wednesday was a nice warm day and Catra took her lunch at the local coffee shop Perfuma worked at. She settled on a table outside with a clear view inside the cafe to people watch. She was utilising her sunglasses to their full potential to shamelessly watch the blonde woman chatting to Perfuma over the counter.

The woman was wearing a crop top and the most perfect pair of black gym shorts that made her ass look fantastic. The woman turned to head out the door, passing Catra where she sat by the door outside. Catra pretended to be øning out and only followed the woman with her eyes to avoid getting caught.

Which is why she noticed the other woman run her eyes over Catra and seemed to enjoy the view. Catra tilted her head to look at the blonde to see if the action would make the blonde act on that look but she just offered a friendly smile and headed down the street. Shame.

I

Friday night Catra considered going out to town to see if she could blow off steam but Weaver had saddled her with a bunch of work and it seemed like too much effort after all.

Around midnight she got a text and glanced at her phone to see the unknown number pop up again. She considered ignoring it but it was hard not to be curious. It was Friday, was this an accidental drunk text?

Unknown number: r u a guy?

Catra stared at the message for a few minutes. It felt weird, the texting style was completely different from the other texts Adora sent. Was this someone else? She scrolled up to see the other texts they had done and was reassured it was the same number. *Does anyone else have Adora's phone?*

Me: Uhno?

Catra put her phone down too quickly and went back to work. She was tired but so close to finishing this case work then she could go to bed.

Her phone dinged again and Catra picked it up to look at.

Unknown number: Yay!

Catra frowned at the text and huffed. It should not be cute. She put her phone down but moments later another text came through.

Unknown number: OMG, I'm so sorry, my housemate sent that. I'm sorry I bothered you again.

Catra laughed softly, quietly patting herself on the back that she noticed that it wasn't Adora even though it didn't matter at all.

Me: A likely story.

She smiled at how quickly the response came now.

Unknown number: I'm serious, it wasn't me. I mean I was curious, but I would have used real words.

Me: Ithought something was fishy . At this stage Ill be expecting a card at Christmas.

Unknown number: eCard, totally doable. Who should Imake it out to?

Catra looked at the message and bit her lip. t was only fair to provide her name, she knew Adora's name. t wasnt like it was her legal name anyway.

Me: Catra, Iexpect there to be abs.

Unknown number: That can be arranged.

Me: Im still waiting for my subscription to start. Pretty disappointing customer service.

Unknown number: Ive got gym tomorrow , Ill make sure to start your subscription.

Me: Ew, going out then to the gym? Are you nuts?

Unknown number: Nuts about fitness, it helps with my work.

Me: Id much rather sleep in. Runs are better in the evening anyway .

Unknown number: Cardio girl, are we?

Me: Dont you look down on me, Ibet Icould outrun you.

Unknown number: Maybe. Iguess well never know .

Catra laughed softly and bit her lip again. She was really enjoying this stupid conversation. It made her heart flutter and it made her feel stupid. Feelings are stupid.

Me: Saves you the embarrassment.

Unknown number: Id definitely win, Itrain cardio three times a week.

Me: Your abs suggest you are all show.

Unknown number: Wow, rude. My muscles are not just for show .

Me: Mmhmm, prove it.

Unknown number: Uh, I'm not sure how to do that.

Catra laughed again despite herself. The way Adora texted really felt like a conversation. Maybe it was the instant messages or she just texted like she talked.

Me: My suggestion would be to do something useful with them. Holding heavy things is pretty easy.

Unknown number: I'm sure I can find something that fits those requirements.

Me: Good, I'll be waiting.

I

"Kyaking!" Entrapata exclaimed down the phone as soon as Catra answered it. No hello, no lead up, just one word.

"Hey T raps" Catra said, trying to get the conversation back on a normal path as she put her phone between her shoulder and ear so she could open Melogs' food packet.

"Y ou didnt want to go paddle boarding, so I thought you might like kayaking. It's much more fast paced, so I've been told," Entrapta explained as Melog meows loudly at being made to wait.

"I know baby ," Catra said to him, finally getting the packet open and putting his food in the bowl.

"I assume you were not speaking to me," Entraptra said and Catra laughed.

"No, T raps, I was talking to Melog, I'm not really into water , if I'm honest," Catra said, it was a childhood fear since she almost drowned in a pool as a kid. She just preferred to keep her feet on solid ground.

"Hm, noted. Grey is a trained lifeguard if that changes your mind?" Entrapta said and Catra snorted.

"Grey?" Catra asked, she felt like she heard that name before, but she could be mistaken. It was probably a common name.

"Yes, Hordaks friend, she is very nice. Ido agree with Hordak's assessment that you would like her," Entrapta said and Catra huf fed.

"What makes you say that?" Catra asked, she still didnt want to go but she was curious.

"She's very tall," Entrapta said and Catra snorted.

"That's it?" Catra asked critically , surely Entrapta could do better than that.

"Oh, shes gay ," Entrapta said as she was reading a bingo card.

"Trap, Idont just like tall gay people," Catra whined as she walked back to her couch to flop down.

"Ihavent seen you date anyone in a while, my data pool is very limited," Entrapta said and Catra snorted.

"Thats fair , Idont want to go kayaking, but if you do something without water involved Imight come to that," Catra said and Entrapta hummed thoughtfully.

"I'll keep that in mind, have a good night," Entrapta said and Catra parroted back before hanging up.

[...]

Unknown number: Thank you for choosing our subscription service. [picture]

Catra was maybe a little too excited to get her first text from Adora but her abs were delightful. Catra wasn't sure if she should reply to the text, but she was sure that her initial thoughts were too thirsty for midday.

Me: Done anything useful with them yet?

Unknown number: If you can tell me what, I'd be happy to provide it.

Catra took a moment to add a new contact into her phone "Abs Subscription" for Adora and grinned at herself. She was working through lunch again and maybe she was a little delirious from not eating breakfast.

Me: How much can you lift?

Abs Subscription: Depends, but about 180kg on average.

Catra had a weird feeling fluttering in her stomach at the knowledge. Catra was a 60kg woman, average height and a bit petite. This woman could lift three times Catra's body weight. It was a little hot.

Me: Show off, that's literally three of me.

Abs Subscription: Wow, you must be really light. My goal is to lift at least two of me.

Catra felt a desire to see what this woman looked like again and it reminded her that she needed real human interaction. She responded with some encouraging words and texted Entrapta to come loiter in her apartment again some time.

I

Abs Subscription: [Picture]

Abs Subscription: Does this count?

Catra noticed the textmessage while on a conference call with a client who was talking non stop about something completely unrelated to their case.

So instead of listening she decided to lift her phone under her camera so she looked like she was still looking at the client and opened the message.

Catra almost choked on her tongue and quickly put her hand over her mouth to cough in order to hide it. She apologised to the client and they restarted their explanation on how their pizza is completely different to the competitors.

She nodded her head, trying to keep her eyes away from the text sitting on her desk as she finished up her call. She let out a long slow breath as she looked back down at the phone and opened it again. The image on her screen was obviously Adora's hair tied up out of the way with a bandana over the top, her back muscles flexing as she lifted what looked like a huge bag of pet food over her shoulder. Her muscles bulged slightly and a light gleen of sweat on her skin.

It took Catra staring at the caption and image for far too long to realise this was Adora doing something useful with her muscles. She was unpacking pet food. Catra bit her lip as she looked at the muscles on display. She was so gay.

Me: Yes, thank you

Abs Subscription: Yay!

Catra snorted at the dorky response and went back to work, or at least she tried.

I

Abs Subscription: [picture]The sun in good

Catra was sitting at her desk in the late afternoon on a Tuesday, barely able to keep her eyes open as she read over a case. She hadnt slept well and was running on fumes. She got an abs subscription texwhich perked her up faster than her 3 cof fees ever did. She hadnt had a texfor a few days and had been wondering why they had stopped. As curious as she was, she didnt feel like it was appropriate to ask.

The picture was of those same chiselled abs and flawless skin but instead of a glimpse of crop tops and gym shorts she could see the straps of a red bikini. Catra felt her eyes widen as she looked at the very appreciated planes of muscle and had to stop her mind running away with thoughts of what the rest of that bikini looked like. She was clearly laying in the sun and a slight tan line was visible where her bikini had moved up her hip.

Catra knew she was being a thirsty mess for someone she had never seen more than their back and abs but she wasnt expecting this abs subscription to be so sexy .

Me: Red is my favourite colour.

Abs Subscription: t makes you go faster .

Catra laughed at her stupid joke, it successfully cut the tension and Catra saved the image before going back to work. She was suddenly feeling a burst of energy.

I

Catra was twirling a curl around her finger as she looked between the two options available for this years cat calendar . She didnt need two, but she almost wanted to buy one of each, it was for a good cause after all. Catra bought the calendar every year to support the animal shelter that she had gotten Melog from three years ago. Her little hairball was the highlight of her life so she had to show her appreciation. She grabbed one of each calendar and a new toy for Melog before turning to ring the service bell.

She heard two sets of footsteps before she heard a voice behind the door as it opened.

Ill grab this, can you get the delivery of f the truck?The lavender haired woman asked someone else behind the door. She heard a response in the affirmative and as the door swung fully open Catra saw a flash of blonde hair as the other person walked away. Catra was starting to wonder if she had a thing for blondes. She was seeing them everywhere as of late. She must have finally lost it.

"Hey Spinny , can Ihave these please?" Catra asked, holding up her spoils.

"Y ou sure can, hows Melog doing?" she asked as she bagged her purchases for her.

"Hes a terror , but Id die for him," Catra said and Spinny laughed.

"Thats good to hear . We are taking on volunteers again by the way. I know you were interested last time," Spinny said and Catra nodded.

"Iwas, Iam really swamped with work right now though, so Ill have to pass this time, but let me know nextime," Catra said with an apologetic look. Spinny nodded.

"Y ou really need to take some time off, all work and no fun doesnt sound much like living," Spinny said and Catra nodded. She was right. t wasnt much of a life, but it would all be worth it in the end… right?

"Thanks Spinny , Ibetter get back to work," Catra said and Spinny looked a little sad for her. Catra ducked her head awkwardly before she qickly left, heading back to work. She was going to seriously consider taking some time off, maybe read a book or something.

I

Abs Subscription: [Picture of Adora' s abs and a very cute labrador]I think Ifound my soulmate.

Catra had been lying in bed mindlessly scrolling on her phone. Her window was open and the sun was just right to warm her legs and keep the rest of her relatively cool. Melog had joined her , sleeping on her thighs in the sun on his back. Catra saw the text and snorted at the caption, she looked down at Melog and without thinking too much about it she snapped a picture of her precious boy.

Me: [Picture of Melog on his back and plenty of bronze thighs. Small sleeping shorts covered in cats]Iprefer cats

Abs Subscription: OMG, what a precious baby, whats their name?

Catra thought for a moment before she decided this wasnt dangerous information to give to a stranger.

Me: Melog, dont let their cute exterior fool you, they are a menace.

Abs Subscription: They are so cute Iwould let them get away with anything. Are they a pure breed?

Me: Its people like you that make them think they are a king. They are a rescue.

Abs Subscription: They are a king, Iwill accept no other option. Ilike your shorts by the way.

Catra blinked at the message, she hadnt really looked at the background behind Melog before sending the image. She looked at the photo and blushed. She had jµst sent a picture of her thighs to a stranger. A personal trainer lesbian who was probably jµdging her workout routine right now because of her soft thighs. Not only that, but she's wearing stupid pyjamas she was given by Scorpia for Christmas three years ago.

She was more than a little embarrassed. She cleared her throat to try to stop her blush as she looked down at Melog.

"This is your fault,"she accused Melog and he jµst mrrped as he adjµsted in her lap to better capture the sun. Catra looked back at her phone, re-reading the last message again as she tried to think of how to respond.

Me: Melog would approve of you as his servant. You better not be jµdging me.

Abs Subscription: Iwould never , Ihave plenty of animal clothing.

Me: That's quite a bold thing to admit, you aren't going to try to sell me a workout plan are you?

Maybe Catra wanted to know what this lesbian thought of the glimpse she got. She was only human.

Abs Subscription: I wouldn't dream of it, you clearly don't need it.

Catra let out a stupid giggle at the confirmation. She cleared her throat trying to get her emotions under control as she laid back against the bed. She felt way better after reading that message than she should. She really needed to do something about this burning need for human contact.

I

Catra finally decided to go out after work on Friday. She didn't invite anyone to go with her because she was a woman on a mission. She was getting laid, she had waited long enough and now it was just getting sad.

She had a terrible work week and just wanted to be close to another human and hopefully get her socks knocked off. Catra made a last minute wardrobe adjustment, unbuttoning her work shirt to show off her cleavage and ruffling her hair back to some semblance of life.

The club she went to had loud music and poor lighting but it made it all the easier to get lost in the rhythm as the songs blurred together.

Catra had been moving to the music under the strobing lights of the dancefloor when a very firm body pushed gently up against her back.

Catra glanced over her shoulder, pleased to see a taller woman with long blonde hair. Blondes really were haunting her. Catra felt like her week was finally going the right way and she didnt even have to do anything more than dance. Her strong hands touched her hips delicately and leaned back into the body behind her.

She couldnt see the woman properly from this angle but she wasnt about to say no to these big hands and flashes of strong forearms she could see. They rocked together, their hips moving in surprisingly good sync from the start. Catra felt the woman lean down to her about half way through their second song together and Catra leaned back into her, arching her back as she slipped her hand into the woman's blonde hair . She felt the woman pull her more firmly against her as she was offered a eyeful down Catra’s open shirt.

Catra was a patient woman, but it had been almost six months and she was beyond horny from their dancing which was thinly veiled grinding at this point. Catra grabbed the woman's hand, noticing how she released her grip on her hips immediately. Catra appreciated the consideration, but laced their fingers together as she led the woman off the dancefloor.

Before they left the light Catra glanced over her shoulder at the blonde. She could only really describe herself as an angel with piercing blue eyes that were dark with desire and built enough to lift Catra without breaking a sweat. Catra hooded her eyes at the woman as they made eye contact and the blonde turned pink under the gaze.

Catra didnt look very hard for a table but she did find a little dark spot near the booths where some make-out and heavy petting could be concealed. She stepped into the dark spot as she turned to the woman, she could barely see anything in the dark but her body was tingling with anticipation. She heard a giggle from the woman and it caused Catra to pause.

"What?" Catra asked, a little confused.

"It's so dark, I can barely see you," she said. Catra was so surprised at the sound of her voice, she even sounded like an angel, maybe a little husky from their dancing but still an angel.

"Ok, if you are going to giggle like a schoolgirl I am obligated to ask your age and how much you've had to drink" Catra drawled and the girl giggled again.

"Fair question, 27 and nothing to drink, you?" the woman responded.

"29 and sober ," Catra replied and pulled the woman close to her by her shoulders.

"No way , Ithought you were older with your sexy business attire," the woman giggled as she found Catra's hips in the dark. Catra was forced to pause again. She would have ignored the comment if she didnt need a little consent and cooperation to make out in the dark.

"Excuse you, this is just normal business wear ,"

"I think it looks sexy , you look like a proper adult"

"W -what do you mean? This is what normal people wear . What are you wearing?" Catra asked, trying to see in the dark as she ran her hands down the woman's strong arms to feel her torso. She met the hem of her jeans but no shirt as she ran her hands up toned abs. She groaned deeply, completely gone for the feel of these glorious dips. The woman giggled at the feeling.

"I cant believe Imissed looking at these," Catra whined as the girl laughed again. "I need you to kiss me now , please,"

"Oh, sure," the woman responded, and after a little touching to find each other they started a very heated makeout session that had Catra completely destroyed.

Catra was very happy that they were in a dark spot because their hands were far too bold to be so sober. Catra broke the kiss to take some much needed deep breaths as the blonde moved to her neck. She rocked her hips forward looking for friction and groaned when a blissfully muscled thigh was offered a tribute.

"Do you want to get out of here? Before we get kicked out for being indecent?" Catra panted as she gripped the blonde' s hair as she kissed her neck.

"Y ep, totally, yes," the girl rushed out and pulled back, "I just have to tell my friend I'm leaving, is that cool?" She asked.

"Y eah, totally," she said as the blonde moved away slightly . "Meet outside?"

"Y eah," the angel said, nodding before she disappeared into the crowd. Catra took a moment to appreciate her back muscles, shown off by her crop top as she walked through the crowd.

Catra went outside, it was cold and she considered buttoning up her shirt against the chill. After a few minutes she started to question if she was getting brushed off when the club door opened. A very loud pink haired woman stumbled out, she looked to be crying a little and the blonde woman came out behind her, holding her up when she stumbled again.

Catra felt completely duped, was she making out with someone with a girlfriend? The blonde spotted her and put her arm around the smaller woman leading her over to Catra.

"Hey ," she said and Catra looked at the quietly sobbing girl.

"Hey" she said looking back at the blue-eyed beauty .

"I'm really sorry to do this, but I didn't realise my friend was so drunk, I need to get her home, can we do a raincheck?" she asked and Catra was so very disappointed.

"Sure" Catra agreed, resigned to just going home after this let down. She wasn't sure if she was getting the brush off, but she sure felt like it.

"Uh, my phones dead, but can I give you my number?" The woman offered and Catra let her eyes trail over her abs before she convinced herself it was worth it.

"Sure, uh," she grabbed her phone and realised it was also dead with a frown. It must have been later than she thought if she was out of battery. "Mines dead too" she said cringing and the blonde looked so disappointed. She adjusted her friend on her shoulder and reached into her friend's bag, grabbing a scrap of paper and a pen. She wrote down her number and handed it to Catra.

Catra smiled, stupidly relieved that they had another option.

"Call me?" The blonde said in earnest and Catra bit her lip.

"Yeah, I can do that," Catra agreed and the blonde smiled so brightly it hurt Catra's eyes.

"Good, have a good night," she said

"Thanks, you too," Catra said, now seeing the woman in the light of the streetlamps, she almost looked familiar somehow. As she walked away, Catra wondered where she had seen her before. She elected to think about it while she got herself a car home.

Once she was safely in a taxi going back to her apartment she spared a glance at the number on the paper she had. She sighed, cursing herself for not checking sooner, it was chicken scratch. She couldn't even tell what the name was. She was going to be alone forever.

I

Catra was laying face down on her bed Sunday night. She was hit with the biggest mood dip she had experienced in a while. Melog was very helpful sleeping in a tight purring ball on her lower back so she was trapped in her depression nest.

Catra’s phone was sitting on the bed beside her, she had been scrolling through social media, looking at all the people out there living their lives and thinking about how empty her life really felt.

Her phone lit up with a text and her heart jumped to cardio levels of excitement as she opened the text

Abs Subscription: Why is dating so hard in my city? No one wants to build a connection.

Catra felt her heart thump uncomfortably in her chest, she wasn't the only one feeling down tonight. Realising that made her feel just a little bit better, at least she wasn't alone in these feelings. Catra knew how it felt to want connection and not be able to find it.

Me: I don't think it's specific to your city , but I can sympathise. It's not easy.

Abs Subscription: Your partner is very lucky to have you.

Catra snorted and frowned. Adora thought she had a partner? That she deserved one. It was a weird feeling. Was this why she wasn't flirting back when Catra flirted with her? Sometimes she did, but she never let it go on for long. What a dummy.

Me: I'm single.

Abs Subscription: Oh? By choice or?...

Me: I'd like one, but I'm really busy with work, I don't have a lot of time.

Abs Subscription: In my experience you make time for what's important.

Catra took a breath, suddenly feeling an oppressive sense of longing. She wanted to make time, she wanted someone to cuddle that could cuddle her back and not scream for breakfast at five in the morning.

Catra let her head drop onto the bed again and sighed. She hated this feeling, it made her feel hollow.

Me: Maybe you're right.

I

"Catra, it's just one date, please. I think you'll really like her" Perfuma pleaded and Catra threw her head back dramatically. They were walking around the park on their monthly catch up and Catra hadn't even started talking about work when Perfuma dropped this on her.

"What are you basing that on?" Catra demanded as she crossed her arms, neither of them were even sweating yet.

"She's really driven, she loves cats, she's super smart! You love smart, driven, cat people!" Perfuma defended and Catra scoffed. She was right and she knew it.

"Are you just describing me? Why would I want to date myself?" Catra demanded just to be difficult and Perfuma almost frowned but smoothed out her features.

"Fine, she's outdoorsy, she loves animals in general, especially horses, and she owns her own business," Perfuma tried again and Catra huffed. Holding up her fingers to mark off each thing.

"I hate the outdoors, I only like cats, and owning your own business is unreliable" Catra said and Perfuma frowned a little. Catra took that as a small achievement.

"You are being very difficult," Perfuma scolded and Catra rolled her eyes.

"Yes, because I hate blind dates and I am not going to agree to one, even if she's six foot and ripped," Catra said and Perfuma's eyes brightened as she smiled.

"Funny you should say that." Perfuma said and Catra hated to admit she stopped to consider it. She never did get any satisfaction from her night out, having dinner with a stranger wasn't so bad was it?

"Have you been talking to Entrapta?" Catra asked suspiciously and Perfuma looked confused. Catra was reasonably sure this wasn't the same tall gay woman Entrapta tried to introduce her to.

"Ok, fine, I'll go on the stupid date," Catra huffed and Perfuma squealed excitedly.

"Perfect, I'll arrange everything, don't worry," Perfuma promised.

"I'm worried," Catra said with a deadpan look.

Catra shouldn't have spent the week fretting about meeting a stranger, she met them all the time. She just didn't want to have an awkward evening with someone who couldn't hold a conversation. She had received a text earlier in the day with details of the date but Perfuma had been strangely secretive about her friend except for

what she had already provided. Catra hoped it was to give them something fun to discuss and not because they were a serial killer.

Catra was getting ready for the date, finishing her eyeliner and looking at herself in the mirror to try to encourage herself. She heard Melog coughing in the other room and paused when he kept coughing.

"You ok?" she called, buttoning her shirt as if he could reply. He just kept coughing and she rushed into the living room. He was coughing harder now, it was like he was coughing up a hairball but it wouldn't come.

"Are you ok?" she asked, Melog looked worried, so Catra was immediately in overprotective mama mode. She wasn't far away from the 24 hour vet so she scooped him up as he kept coughing and rushed out of the house.

After hours at the vet and a two thousand dollar bill Catra was so relieved that she had taken him to the vet when they found a piece of plastic stuck in his throat. She had to leave him overnight for observations. She managed to text Perfuma to let her know to tell her friend she couldn't make it. It was disappointing after spending so long getting ready but she would literally jump into fire to save her baby.

She took a photo of Melog drugged off his face in his little bed for the night and promised she would be back to get him in the morning.

Catra drove home and sat in her living room in the dark. Her house felt so lonely without Melog and she hated it.

Melog was okay, she had to remind herself of that, he would be home tomorrow and she was going to keep an eye on him. She didnt care about the money but she really missed him right now .

She took out her phone and opened her chat with Perfuma.

Me: [picture of Melog]They are ok now , but Ihave to leave them overnight.

Perfuma: Im so relieved, Im sure they will make him comfortable and he cant wait to be home again.

Me: Thanks. What did you tell the girl?

Perfuma: Just something urgent came up, Ididnt want to overshare your business.

Me: Iappreciate that, thanksmy house is really quiet.

Perfuma: Scorpia just finished making dinner , wanna come watch a movie with us?

Me: Sure, Ill be over soon.

I

Catra was sitting at a ramen place she had been meaning to try for literal years. She decided to take herself out on a date after all the stress about Melogs vet visit and recovery. So she treated herself to something better than frozen ready meals. The ramen was so delicious she had to stop herself from moaning in delight.

She was trying to be present and in the moment but when her message tone dinged and she got her phone out to check. She was pleasantly surprised that it was Adora. No pictures this time, but they had started talking more without the guise of ab photos. t has been really nice and Catra has enjoyed it more than she expected.

Abs Subscription: Got some sad news, can you send me pictures of your kitty?

Catra smiled sadly at the message, she hoped Adora was ok. She went through her huge collection of Melog pictures and sent a few she hadnt sent Adora already .

Abs Subscription: That helps a lot. Thank you. Ithink this one is my favourite. Picture of Melog squishing his face up against Catra' s

chest while she holds him like a baby]

Catra bit her lip and tried to hold in her giggle. Adora had finally gotten with the program and started flirting with Catra when they talked. It was every bit as fun as she wanted it to be.

Me: Jealous?

Abs Subscription: You have no idea [winky face]

I

After Melog's huge vet bill was paid and he was back to his wicked ways Catra felt like she could finally breathe again.

Catra decided that it was time to make time for herself. She knew it wasn't the same thing but if Melog could go to hospital being the preciously cared for angel he is, her burning the candle at both ends was going to catch up with her. So she did what she always wanted to do, she booked time off.

She got the third degree from Weaver, telling her she thought she was stronger than that. She even gave her more work to make up for the time she was going to be away. It was only a week, they could survive without her for one week.

t was the longest week of her life waiting for her time of f to come. Catra had picked out a book she always wanted to read and decided she was going to the cafe Perfuma worked at to do just that.

She set up in the sun outside and ordered a coffee and when that ran out she got a tea and she read for hours. She caught herself giggling to herself as she enjoyed the silly story and crazy romantic plot. She felt truly relaxed for the first time in years. Maybe she should do this more often.

She was so engrossed that she didnt notice the blonde come in but she did notice her leaving. The woman had two coffees and called back a goodbye to Perfuma as she left through the door.

Catra snapped her head up, forgetting that she wasnt wearing her sunglasses and making possibly the most startled eye contact she had ever made in her life. The blonde also looked startled by her sudden movement before she smiled in that same friendly manner she always did when they shared a glance.

Catra felt a bit like an idiot for her reaction and felt her cheeks redden. The woman lifted her hand like she was going to tip the brim of a cowboy hat she was absolutely not wearing and blushed as she realised her mistake. Catra blushed like a southern belle at the motion, was she a cowboy?

The blonde walked down the steps to the sidewalk much faster than usual and Catra watched her go with a strange feeling at the back of

her head. A sense of familiarity hit her suddenly in the wake of those blue eyes.

Catra looked back inside the cafe and saw Perfuma look away, she was definitely watching. Catra huffed and closed her book. She knew someone who would have answers to where Catra had seen that blonde before.

"Who was that?" Catra asked as soon as she got to the counter, motioning to the door like it explained everything and Perfuma hadnt had more customers since the blonde left.

"Who?" Perfuma asked, trying to look innocent but she couldnt pull it off.

"The blonde who was just in here with the two coffees," Catra specified, trying not to use descriptors that would incriminate herself. Perfuma tipped her head as she tapped her finger to her chin like she was thinking.

"Oh? Grey?" Perfuma asked and something started to prickle at the back of Catra's mind like a memory demanding her attention. She had no idea where she had heard that name before.

"Is that a person or a colour?" Catra said, rolling her eyes as she crossed her arms.

"T echnically Grey is a tone," Perfuma said, handing someone their tea and thanking them. Catra sighed as loudly as she could and Perfuma finally gave in to her childish antics.

"My friend, Grey . Tall, muscular, owns her own business, likes animals," Perfuma said and Catra frowned in confusion.

"Why are you describing her like that? This isnt a dating show ," Catra glared and Perfuma giggled.

"No, Isuppose not. Y ou never did go on that date," Perfuma said and Catra felt her stomach sink.

"W ait, that was the girl you were setting me up with?" Catra said looking back outside like she could catch another glimpse of this Grey.

"Y ep," Perfuma said in a singsong voice.

"Why didnt you try to do another date?" Catra was suddenly pissed at missing out on such good real estate.

"You never asked, I thought you weren't interested," Perfuma shrugged her shoulders.

"I didn't know she looked like THAT," Catra waved her arm towards the door right as the ringer went off and someone stepped inside.

Perfuma's grin spread even wider at the sight of the person. Catra expected to turn and see Scorpia or someone Perfuma hadn't seen in years because of the excitement on her face.

"Forget something, Grey?" Perfuma sing-songed and the blonde appeared to be blushing and Catra was horrified to realise her arm was still motioning to the door. She dropped it immediately and fought her own blush.

"Uh, yeah, the croissant," the blonde said as she rubbed the back of her neck and her bicep bulged delightfully.

This was the second time Catra forgot she wasn't wearing her glasses as she freely admired the blonde.

"Of course, I'll just grab it," Perfuma said, disappearing out the back. Catra's eyes reached the blonde's face after her slow perusal and saw a slight smirk there. Catra felt that weird needling in her head at the familiar expression as Catra lost the battle with her burning cheeks.

The blonde took a deep breath, looking a little nervous for a moment as she stepped closer to Catra.

"You, uh, never called," The blonde said in a whispered tone and Catra just stared at her in complete confusion.

"Uh, excuse me?" Catra asked, her mouth hanging open a little. The blonde looked between her two toned eyes and seemed to see how confused she was.

"I get it if you aren't interested. I'd just like to be upfront about it," The woman continued and Catra started to frown. If she had this woman's number she would have called her so fast.

"Uh, can we back up a bit? When did I get your number?" Catra asked, gripping her book too hard as she wracked her brain for anything not work-related over the last few months.

"Uh, at the club?" The woman said and Catra's eyes widened. The blonde suddenly looked much more familiar than just their random coffee shop passing.

"W-what! Your writing is terrible! How was I meant to decipher that?" Catra asked and the blonde chuckled. Despite her melodic voice, her chuckle was deeper and it sent a shiver down Catra's spine.

"That explains it but didn't you recognise me?" She asked and Catra blushed as she looked away.

"No, I didn't get a good look at you at the club," Catra said and the woman laughed again.

"Well you must have seen enough," Catra glanced at the blonde and that stupidly hot smirk was back.

"I meant I'd like to see more," Catra said, leaning into the flirting so they could quickly brush over her stupidity . She sent the blonde her own cocky smirk that made the blonde blush slightly but she looked pleased.

"That can be arranged" The blonde responded and Catra moved to grab her phone. She frowned in confusion when she pet the pockets of her jeans. She suddenly remembered that she left her phone at home to make sure she didn't get distracted from her book.

"Oh my god," Catra said and groaned as she tipped her head back. She lifted her head and glared at the blonde before she looked her over.

"You don't happen to have your phone in those tiny shorts do you?" Catra asked and the woman laughed.

“Unfortunately not, no pockets,” The blonde said and Catra sighed, the universe hated her.

“How about we do it the old fashion way ,” Adora said, grabbing one of the napkins off the counter.

Catra felt weird about leaving this meeting up to fate again and stupidly absent phones. They can exchange numbers and maybe it will be fine but her everything had been working against her lately and she wants to be certain. Apparently the blonde felt the same.

“Actuallywhat are you doing right now?” The woman asked with a determined look in her eyes that Catra loved to see.

“Just reading,” she said, waving her kind of embarrassing book choice in explanation.

“Great, my phone is just at the gym down the road, would you like to take a walk with me?” She asked and looked like an endearing mix between confident and shy as she asked to spend time with Catra.

Catra bit her lip to try to hide the wide smile but it did nothing to taper her delight. “Yeah, I’d like that,” Catra agreed, proud of herself for following this feeling.

"Great! Great," The woman said, energy levels cranking up immediately and Catra laughed a little. "Do you want a drink? Let me get you something," the woman asked with her big excited blue eyes that made Catra want to melt like an embarrassing mess.

"That's ok, I've already had a coffee and like three cups of tea," Catra said, already too caffeinated for her heart to be beating this fast.

"Are you sure? Maybe juice?" she asked and Catra laughed and shook her head.

"I'm ok, thank you for offering though," Catra said and the woman grinned bright as the sun. Catra heard the door to the back room finally open and Perfuma miraculously was finished doing whatever she was doing to the croissant and appeared behind the counter again.

"Here you go Grey , sorry for the delay," Perfuma sang and handed over the food. Grey took it and smiled.

"All good, totally worth the wait," She said and smiled at Catra. Catra grinned. "See you later , Fuma" Grey said and opened the door for Catra. Catra tried not to blush but she was so aware of Perfuma watching them as they left together.

Catra really did have gym blindness. The gym was only about six buildings down from the cafe which she walked past every morning on her way to work. She was surprised she had never noticed it before.

Despite their quiet walk there it didn't feel awkward, it felt far too comfortable for strangers. They both seemed to relax from their excitement right as they entered the air conditioned gym and a loud, excited voice screamed "WLDCA T."

Catra was startled but recognised Scorpia's voice immediately, she was quick enough to duck away from her sweaty hug successfully .

"W ow, hold it, you are not hugging me while you're dripping with sweat!" Catra said, stopping Scorpia' s second attempt with a scowl.

"Oh, sugar! Sorry , I still have to take a shower , what are you doing here? Y ou hate gyms," Scorpia said, bouncing with excitement. Catra did hate gyms but it did make her feel a little guilty that Scorpia wanted her to workout with her so badly.

"Y eah, I'm just visiting," Catra explained a little awkwardly as she glanced at Grey, who was silently watching their exchange. Once Scorpia noticed Grey the blonde silently handed Scorpia one of the coffee cups and the pastry.

"Oh, thanks buddy!" Scorpia said with so much enthusiasm.

"Do you two know each other?" Grey asked curiously , but before Catra could answer, Scorpia launched into an explanation.

"Of course! Wildcat and I are best friends!" Scorpia said proudly and Catra laughed at her excitement.

"How do you know Scorpia?" Catra asked curiously .

"Through Perfuma, we went to school together" the blonde said and Catra frowned. Perfuma was two years younger than her but she went to the same school. No way…

"Wait did we go to the same school?" Catra asked and Grey smiled down at her. Her smile was filled with fond wonderment.

"I guess we did" She said a little in awe, and Catra huffed. "Let me grab my phone, stay right here," The woman said and Catra couldn't help her grin.

"Ok," Catra agreed and Grey beamed.

"Ok, good, ok" she said and headed further into the gym. Catra bit her lip before she looked back at Scorpia. She kind of forgot she was

there and blushed at the stary eyes on her best friend's face.

"Aww, Ididn't know you knew Grey ," Scorpia said with excitement.

"We just met at the cafe," Catra said, deciding to ignore their first meeting since it was a bust.

"Aw, what a cute story that will make," Scorpia said and Catra blushed. Scorpia had exactly no chill and was probably planning their wedding right now.

"Maybe," Catra said. When Grey reappeared with her phone, Catra had all but forgotten what she was wearing and decided to reacqaint herself with Grey's tiny gym shorts and strappy sports bra.

Grey stopped before her and Catra made eye contact with the darker blue eyes again. She remembered those eyes now, dark with desire under the strobing lights of the dance floor. Scorpia cleared her throat.

"I'll go shower , then we can go to the stables," Scorpia said and Grey smiled at her.

"Sounds good, take your time," The blonde said as Scorpia disappeared further into the gym. Adora unlocked her phone and handed it to Catra.

"Thanks," Catra said and put her number into the phone, but instead of the option to add a contact, it came up with her name.

Catra [Emoj: Cat, kissy face, tanned leg]

Catra stared at it, unsure what that meant. Grey obviously noticed and moved closer to see what had caught her attention.

"Wait, Catra?" Grey asked and Catra blinked up at her a little owlishly. She was so confused about what was happening. How did this woman already have her name and number on her phone? What did the emoj's mean?

"Yes?" she asked, her voice sounded so small and the blonde laughed.

"I didnt think you lived in Brightmoon," Grey said, shaking her head.

"I'm confused again," Catra said and Grey tried to take her phone, which Catra held against her chest instead.

“Here, I’ll show you,” Grey said and Catra nodded her head, feeling a little silly for not returning her phone immediately. Grey clicked around on her phone and pulled up a text conversation. “Here” she offered the phone back, and Catra took it. Her eyes were so wide as she looked through their conversations from the other side.

“Adora?” Catra said softly and looked up at her and Adora laughed.

“Yeah, what are the odds?” Adora said with a bright smile. She seemed far too relaxed about this turn of events. “I must be fate or something,” she said with a chuckle and Catra frowned deeply .

“I was right, that woman was an idiot,” Catra said as her eyes moved down to the abs she had been thirsting for for months at this point. Adora laughed.

“It’s alright,” Adora said and Catra frowned deeper .

“Actually , no, I’m an idiot!” Catra said suddenly . “You were my blind date!” Catra said, holding Adora’ s phone tightly again. Adora smiled, she was so full of warmth and it made Catra tingle all over. Adora put her hand out and Catra returned her phone. She gave a lopsided smile.

“Well, it seems you’ve already got my number, so when are we going out?” Adora asked and Catra grinned.

“I mean, I’ve got this week off. So you just name the time and place,” Catra said and Adora looked incredibly excited by the prospect.

“I have to go to the stables right now, but tonight?” Adora said with hopeful eyes and Catra blinked at her.

“You are a cowboy,” Catra said without thinking and Adora laughed.

“Not exactly, I train therapy horses” Adora said with an easy smile, and Catra gawked at her.

“What?! Why do you have to be so ripped to do that?” Catra asked, her eyes sliding down Adora’s frame again. Adora laughed.

“It helps, horses are big and you can’t let them push you around while they are learning,” Adora said with a shrug and Catra nodded. She knew nothing of horses, except that they were pretty and in a surprising amount of romance novels she had read over the years.

“So, where are we going?” Catra asked, holding her book to her chest as she looked at Adora with hooded eyes.

"Do you like paddle boarding?" Adora asked and Catra looked at her in shock and laughed.

"Oh my godd o you know Entrapta?" Catra asked and Adora looked confused for a moment and laughed.

"Entrapta and Hordak?" Adora asked, and Catra nodded "Y eah? Why?" Catra shook her head.

"I m just starting to realise how small Brightmoon is. I don't like water much," Catra clarified and Adora nodded.

"Scared or general dislike?" Adora asked curiously and Catra bit her lip, electing to tell the truth.

"I almost drowned as a kid so I avoid it now ," Catra said simply , and Adora smiled like Catra had given her a great gift.

"Ok, let's not terrify you on the first date," Adora said and Catra felt butterflies in her stomach as she thought of them having more than one date. Catra felt excitement like she had never really felt before. She felt like this could be something.

[..]

Catra got home in the mid afternoon, feeling warm and happy from her victory. She sat on her couch to snuggle Melog for a few minutes as she felt the butterflies in her chest as she thought of Adora. What were the odds? Maybe it really was fate. Catra thought back to the sneaky kiss they shared before parting ways and her knees still felt weak at the memory.

Catra had literal hours before she needed to get ready but she was so full of energy that she couldnt seem to calm down. Catra was looking into her fridge considering what she could possibly bake before her date when her phone started ringing.

She had left it on loud so she didnt miss any message from Adora and she was confused at the sound of her ringer. She would have to change that. She saw Bow's name on her phone and she grinned.

"Hey Bow ," she greeted, putting her phone between her ear and shoulder as she got things out of her fridge.

"Hey Catra, word on the grapevine is you've taken annual leave, should be worried?"

"Har har , Im fine thank you very much. How's your pinning going?" Catra said she had forgotten to check in as much as she should, but

she wanted to hear all about the drama, which had sustained their gossip sessions over the years.

"Really good actually , Itold her how Ifeel," Bow said and Catra gasped.

"Good for you buddy! How did that go?" Catra asked and Bow chuckled.

"She went out with a mutual friend and came home completely trashed and sobbing,"

"Y ikes," Catra said playfully .

"Y eah, she very loudly told me she loved me and she didnt know how to exist in a world that Ididnt know that, it washonestly really romantic" Bow said with a little laugh and Catra grinned.

"Y ou sap,"

"So, Itold her Iloved her and put her to bed. She forgot the whole thing the next morning, but it was out there so Itold her again, we've been dating for a few weeks now," Bow said and Catra felt her chest swell, she was so happy for him that after all these years he got to be with Glimmer.

"She's a lucky girl, I wish you could have done it in high school, but like, better late than never," Catra teased and Bow laughed.

"Yeah, well things happen for a reason. I hope it means we are stronger now that we know ourselves better," Bow said and Catra thought of Adora, she wondered what it would have been like to know her in high school. Maybe Bow remembered her.

"Hey, do you know Adora Grey?" Catra asked and Bow laughed.

"Of course, Adora is Glimmer's best friend, they've been besties since primary school," Bow said and continued with a laugh in his voice "She comes to all our parties" Catra felt a little guilty, she hadn't been to many of those, preferring to work or just sleep if possible.

"Unlike me you mean?" Catra said, feeling sulky.

"I didn't mean it like that, but it would be nice to see you more often, I worry about you working so much," Bow said and the genuine care in his voice made Catra feel less like a bad friend.

"I know, I think I'm going to work on that," Catra said softly.

"That's good to hear . Why did you ask about Adora?" Bow asked and she could hear the smile in his voice. She blushed.

"Oh, uh, well I met her at the cafe today and we are going out tonight," Catra said and Bow made a squealing noise which was loud enough to disrupt Melog on her lap.

"I've said for years that you two would be adorable together , I'm so glad you finally met," Bow said with delight and Catra blushed.

"Why didn't you introduce us?" Catra asked.

"Catra, you are so stubborn you wouldn't have listened. It's better that it happened organically," Bow said with a laugh. "I'm just thrilled, what are you going to wear?"

"Oh, uh, well." Catra sprung into a description of several outfits she was considering.

[..]

Adora Grey: It was a pleasure to finally meet you.

Me: You're just saying that because I let you kiss me.

Adora Grey: I mean it doesn't hurt. I'm excited for our date.

Me: me too, I hope you like heights.

Adora Grey: I love them.

[..]

Catra was dressed in tight black jeans with rips down the front showing off her caramel skin. She had a tight maroon coloured singlet over her chest and her leather jacket over the top. She wore boots since the days were getting shorter and colder and she needed to be warm going to the cliff. Her hair was in a messy tangle of curls and she even did her makeup.

She packed a collection of snacks and food in a picnic basket. Adora had assured her that she would eat anything and Catra believed her. A picnic at the cliff would be perfect to get to know each other and maybe cuddle a little for warmth.

Adora came to pick her up in her truck which looked to be newly cleaned, and Catra may have struggled to get up into it with her

short legs. Adora didn't laugh at her but did put a hand on her lower back to stop her toppling out again.

Catra blushed but smiled at Adora as she placed the picnic basket on the chair beside her. They still had plenty of time before sunset to get to the cliff and Catra was buzzing with excitement.

"This is a really cute idea," Adora said as she drove them to their location.

"Yeah, well, I have to make up for the brush off," Catra said, trying to apologise without saying it.

"You don't have to worry about that, I'm just glad you're here now," Adora said softly and took Catra's hand. Catra tried to keep her smile to a normal amount but it was hard to cage.

They arrived at the cliff overlooking the ocean. It was pretty secluded and Adora parked her truck to help cut the wind coming from down the coast. Catra set up a picnic blanket and set out the copious amounts of food as Adora watched with interest. She looked so good in her nice jeans and button up shirt. Catra hadn't gotten a good look at the pattern but it was a light blue with dark blue shapes, maybe leaves?

"Wow, Catra, this all looks amazing," Adora said in awe of the food. Catra liked to cook but she never had much time or energy. Today

she found herself with several hours available after confirming her outfit with Bow and so much extra energy to burn that she cooked too much for their picnic.

"Thanks, I don't get much time to cook anymore, I kind of missed it," Catra said a little shyly, but Adora smiled at her with so much fondness that she didn't know how to react. She grabbed the closest thing, which was a savoury muffin she made with bacon and cheese and offered it to Adora.

"Please eat, you told me you'd eat anything," Catra said with a slight challenge in her voice that made Adora laugh.

"That's true," Adora said in a slightly lower tone that made Catra shiver. She bit her lip when Adora took the muffin and Catra elected to not watch her eat it. She quickly grabbed something to put in her own mouth but it didn't take long for conversation to flow like they were old friends.

They gravitated toward each other as the sun slipped below the horizon until they were sitting close enough to lean into each other's warmth. Catra was full of stupid giddy feelings when she was this close to Adora. She looked beautiful in the light of the setting sun.

Adora was a very focused person, or at least she had an unyielding focus on Catra. She was listening to Catra's stories about work while she rubbed small circles into her arm. She was acting like this was

the most interesting thing she had ever heard and laughed at Catra's little commentaries about her job.

A brief silence fell between them as Catra finished her story and Adora was watching her with those soft blue eyes. Catra couldnt resist rocking forward to kiss the blonde. Catra was right in her first assessment all those weeks ago at the club, Adora was an angel, through and through.

When their lips met Catra moved her hands to the collar of her shirt to pull her closer and was rewarded with a small sound from the blonde. Catra felt her body light on fire from the sound. Catra groaned as she felt the blonde lightly grip her waist.

Catra pushed Adora, forcing her onto her back to lay on top of her. The blonde made a pleased hum at this turn of events and put her hands on Catra's back to gently run them up and down. They kissed heatedly for a few minutes until it turned sweet and a little lazy , like they had all the time in the world.

Catra pulled back from the kiss to see the blonde looking a little dazed and Catra gave her a cocky smirk.

"Wow," The blonde whispered and Catra huffed a laugh. She was close enough to see the flecks of grey in Adora's eyes but she also noticed something else she hadnt before.

“Adora is. this shirt covered in horses?” Catra asked in surprise as she looked at the pattern on Adora’s nice shirt. Adora laughed.

“I told you I have clothes with animals on them. I was serious.” Adora said with a grin as she ran her hands up and down Catra’s sides like she was petting her. Catra kind of loved it.

Catra was still adjusting to the idea that all those anonymous texts that gave her life over the last few months were the woman in front of her. Or rather, under her.

“You’re lucky you are hot enough to pull it off,” Catra said with a huff and went back to kissing Adora firmly before she could respond.

Adora was obviously trying not to smile into the kiss and it was making it hard to kiss her. Catra bit her lower lip in abolishment and the blonde moaned. It wasn’t the outcome Catra was trying to get but she would take it. She pushed herself down against the blonde a little harder and Adora pulled her impossibly closer.

[..]

They finished their picnic and made-out long after sunset until it was too cold to stay out any longer.

"Can Imeet Melog?" Adora asked as she parked outside Catra' s apartment complex and Catra grinned.

"Of course," Catra said, like she hadnt already thought of several excuses to get the blonde to come inside. Adora grinned happily as they walked up to her apartment holding hands.

Catra opened her door and after the pair entered the apartment, Melog started to scream his greeting. Adora cooed at the black hairball and crouched to let him sniff her hand. After a tentative sniff, Melog butted his little head against her hand and Adora looked up at Catra with wide-eyed excitement.

Catra was watching with a smile, Melog didnt like everyone, often snubbing people Catra used to bring home but he clearly liked Adora. t was a good sign, not that the blonde was giving her anything but green lights so far.

"My cat likes you, so Iguess you can never leave," Catra said playfully, and Adora snorted far too cutely.

"That sounds reasonable,"

End Notes

Iam tempted to write the time skip dates for Catra and Adora doing all the things Catra turned down during the fic. But let me know if you wanna see it.

What did you think?<3

Thanks for reading!

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